satellite was sent from Soviet Union. During the Janata government's tenure, it was expected that there would be drastic changes in the foreign policy posture of India. This was specially because they vehemently criticized India's intimacy with the Soviet Union as a violation of the principle of non-alignment. However, it got itself reconciled with the tilt in non-alignment and continued good relations with the Soviet Union.

With the coming back of Indira Gandhi, relations became more cordial which were further strengthened by Rajiv Gandhi. Rajiv Gandhi went on his first visit to Moscow from 21–26 May 1985, which resulted in fruitful interactions in strategic as well as economic fields. The return visit by the Soviet President Mikhail Gorbachev to India in November 1986, was a landmark in India's relation with the Soviet Union. New agreements were signed between India and the Soviet Union in the field of economic and technical cooperation. During all these years one thing that was happening was that there was voluminous rise of bilateral trade between both the countries. The National Front Government under V.P. Singh and then Chandra Sekhar did not dramatically change Indo-Russian policy and continued the same traditional policy of amity and cooperation.

With the disintegration of the Soviet Union in December 1991 problems surfaced. There was no clear idea about what the Russian policy towards India would be. Yeltsin and his close associates like Gaider and Kosyrev were pro-West. Therefore, Indo-Russian relations suffered a setback. In the meantime, the historic Indo-Soviet Treaty of Peace and Friendship and Cooperation was extended for another two decades. Several irritants cropped up regarding the cryogenic deals, arms transfer, rupee-rouble exchange, and Kashmir issue among others. Narasimha Rao Government had to renegotiate various ties in place with the erstwhile Soviet Union. India also slipped from the privileged position, which it used to enjoy under the erstwhile USSR. To India's greatest dissatisfaction, Russia voted in favour of a Pakistani-sponsored resolution declaring South Asia a nuclear-free zone. The supply of cryogenic engines by Moscow to aid India's space programme for peaceful explorations, ultimately disrupted under immense US pressure, also created apprehensions in Indian minds.